



The Humanitas Institute

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Knox Classical School  
School Website: <https://www.knoxkc.org/>

December 22, 2025

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**Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

**ACCS Member School**

*Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Executive Summary

Knox Classical School KS 66219 presents a consistently classical, Christian model across public materials and internal communications. The school foregrounds a Christ-centered, biblically integrated framework, explicit engagement with Great Books and the Great Conversation, and a Trivium-based curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric) supplemented by the Quadrivium through depth in mathematics, music, and sciences. Pedagogical methods emphasize contemplative (Schol  ) rhythms in lower grades and Socratic discussion in upper grades, with strong emphasis on memorization, recitation, and virtue formation. Parents are positioned as co-teachers and partners in a two-day, home-optional pedagogical model. Taken together, these signals align Knox KS 66219 with a Classical, Christian, Collaborative approach and yield a firm CLASSICAL rating overall.

Key signals include explicit statements about:

- Religious & metaphysical foundations: Christ-centered, biblically integrated education, and a stated Mission/Vision with a Statement of Faith driving curricular framing. Evidence and framing appear across the site's mission pages and theology-focused postings.
- Purpose & goals: Formation of virtue and wisdom through a classical paideia, virtue-centered aims, and the Great Conversation as a core pedagogical aim.
- Curriculum: Liberal-arts emphasis (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Great Books, Great Conversation, and a clear Trivium/Quadrivium framework, with specific notes on memorization and catechesis as core features.
- Pedagogy: Lower grades incorporate singing/chanting and memory work; upper grades employ Socratic seminars and rhetoric training; Bildung via "habits" and virtuous formation is highlighted.
- Faculty: Public materials describe faculty as experienced, committed, mission-aligned, with living-curriculum emphasis and strong teacher leadership.
- Parents & Community: Explicit partnership with parents as co-teachers, open invitation for visits, and family-centered planning, including at-home days and parent formation materials.

### Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Abstracts of category-specific keyword analyses and scoring follow, with concrete textual evidence and alignment to the Six Essential Elements rubric.

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## Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

### Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials foreground a Christ-centered, biblically integrated approach to education, with explicit references to mission, vision, and a Statement of Faith guiding curricular framing. This is reflected in statements about helping students “love God, love others, and rightly love themselves” and in the emphasis on biblical integration across subjects. - A central blog post articulates a Christ-centered, biblical foundation for education, including explicit calls to theology as a governing discipline, and exemplifies a biblical worldview permeating curriculum. - The school presents a biblical orientation through explicit scriptural framing (e.g., Colossians 1:17 and other biblical references cited in the curriculum narrative).

Positive Keyword Analysis - Present positive religious metaphysical keywords: Christ-centered, biblical, theology, Statement of Faith, biblical integration, Colossians 1:17, “Living God” in classroom inquiry, worship/-communal form (implied by liturgical rhythm in the lexicon materials). - Notable phrases in public materials align with Positive Keywords (truths about God’s sovereignty and Christ as center of all learning; biblical integration of all disciplines).

Quantitative Estimate - Positive keywords evidenced: 5–7 distinct positive terms/themes (Christ-centered, biblical, theology, Statement of Faith, biblical integration, Colossians 1:17, living God references). - Negative keywords: 0 clear negative signals in the public materials studied (no explicit relativism or secular ethics framing detected in core materials).

Why this rating - The materials routinely anchor learning in a transcendent, real, knowable God and the Bible as the governing source of meaning and knowledge. This is the strongest foundational signal in classical education as defined by the Six Essential Elements, and Knox KS 66219 consistently demonstrates Grounded in Theology and Liturgical/Communal framing through its public messaging and specific theological emphases. CLASSICAL status is warranted.

Citations - Christ-centered, mission-driven framing: Knox Classical School materials. - Biblically integrated education and biblical worldview permeating curriculum: Biblically Integrated Education posting. - Scriptural framing of the curriculum (Colossians 1:17, etc.): Public materials referencing biblical worldview across subject threads.

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### Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Foundational formation goals are explicit: virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing are presented as the telos of education, with a deliberate emphasis on forming character and guidance toward human excellence rather than mere job-readiness. This is reinforced by virtue-centered statements and by the Great Conversation orientation. - There are explicit references to education as formation (habits of the heart, virtue formation) rather than information transfer. Public content discusses forming habits conducive to virtue and character, with quotes tying memory work and catechesis to long-term character outcomes. - Great Conversation and Great Books are positioned as core, aligning with the classical telos of forming wise, discerning minds through enduring texts.

Positive Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education/paideia, classical mission, telos, contemplation (Scholé), great conversation, classical heritage, human excellence, moral imagination. - The school’s messaging explicitly elevates virtue formation and the pursuit of true/beautiful as central aims.

Quantitative Estimate - Positive keywords evidenced: 5–7 themes (formation; virtue; wisdom; telos; Great Conversation; contemplation/scholé; human flourishing). - Negative keywords: 0 explicit signals about job-readiness or workforce-centric formation found in core public messaging.

Why this rating - Knox KS frames education as formation of character and wisdom with a classical telos, rather than mere information transfer or job preparation. This aligns squarely with the Positive Keyword indicators for Element 2 and supports a CLASSICAL rating.

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Citations - Formation and virtue emphasis; telos framing: Knox KS public messaging. - Formation over information (habits, catechesis, virtue): Habits and Virtues Framework content. - Great Conversation / Great Books as central curriculum aim: The Great Conversation material.

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### **Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Liberal arts core: The Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium framing are explicit, with grammar-stage and logic/rhetoric-stage delineations described in public materials and blog posts. This is reinforced by a structured grammar-logic-rhetoric progression and by the emphasis on Latin study and classical languages. - Great Books and Great Conversation: The curriculum is described as engaging with Great Books, the Great Conversation, and primary sources, linking to Western civilization's canon and the biblical worldview. - Memorization, catechesis, and intentional formation: Public materials emphasize extensive memory work (catechism, history timelines) and memory-based discipline in early grades. - Experience of wonder: The curriculum narrative stresses integration of wonder with the learning process, including memorization, living books, and the aim to cultivate awe and reverence for truth.

Positive Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts, Trivium, Quadrivium, memory work, catechesis, Great Books, Great Conversation, Western civilization, living books, historical/canonical depth, biblical literacy, Latin/classical languages, unity of truth across subjects, integration and wonder. - The public materials align with all major curriculum criteria in the Six Elements.

Quantitative Estimate - Positive keywords evidenced: 6–8 distinct curriculum keywords/themes (Trivium, Quadrivium, Great Books/Great Conversation, memory work/catechesis, liberal arts, canonical texts, Latin/classical language, integrated/wonder). - Negative keywords: 0 explicit signals of non-classical curriculum (e.g., “STEM-first,” “social studies replacement,” or “project-based-only” orientations) detected.

Why this rating - The explicit articulation of classical curricular components (grammar-logic-rhetoric; Great Books; liberal-arts framework; memorization; wonder) supports a CLASSICAL designation.

Citations - Trivium/Quadrivium, grammar-stage logic-rhetoric progression: Public materials on curriculum. - Great Books / Great Conversation / Western civilization: Great Conversation materials. - Memorization, catechesis, and memory work in grammar: Grammar-stage description.

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### **Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Lower-school pedagogy emphasizes memory work, singing/chanting, and recital as memory-enhancement and engagement devices, consistent with classical pedagogy. Texts describe the grammar-stage use of songs and chants to memorize and delight in learning. - Upper-school pedagogy emphasizes Socratic discussion, seminars, and rhetoric training, with students preparing speeches and arguments as part of the program. The public materials explicitly describe Socratic dialogue, rhetorical training, and the Great Conversation as core teaching modes. - Scholé/restful learning and contemplative pacing are embedded in the pedagogy (especially in lower grades), with emphasis on rest, contemplation, and the formation of virtuous habits.

Positive Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: singing/chanting, memorization/recitation, catechesis, liturgical calendar integration, Socratic seminars, dialectic, rhetoric training, memory work, scholé, wonder-based pedagogy, careful questioning, guided discussion.

Quantitative Estimate - Positive keywords evidenced: 6–8 distinct pedagogy keywords/themes (Socratic/semantics, memory work, recitation, singing/chanting, liturgy/Scholé, rhetoric, dialectic, guided discussion). - Negative keywords: 0 explicit signals of non-classical pedagogy; no wholesale move to exclusively project-based or standardized, non-discursive formats observed in core materials.

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Why this rating - The teaching methods described align tightly with the classical-pedagogy model (Socratic, rhetorical, memory-based recitation, and contemplative pedagogy). CLASSICAL rating is warranted.

Citations - Lower-grade singing/chanting and memory work: Grammar-stage pedagogy. - Upper-grade Socratic/seminar/rhetoric training: Socratic discussions and rhetoric training in public materials. - Contemplative pacing / Scholé: Pedagogical notes on restfulness and contemplation.

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### **Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The school publishes detailed faculty pages and headshots, with descriptions of faculty experience and subject-area strengths (e.g., humanities, Latin, composition), emphasizing veteran teachers and mentors who model virtue and mastery. Public materials feature named faculty and their roles, illustrating the living-curriculum concept. - There is explicit emphasis on the living curriculum and on faculty as core to mission and formation, including statements about faculty as the “portrait of what a teacher should be” and “cultivation of virtue” through teaching. Public materials and blog post content emphasize faculty leadership and teacher excellence.

Positive Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, model teachers/mentors, faculty as core, portrait of a teacher, collegial culture, master-teacher model, virtue formation in faculty, teacher leadership.

Quantitative Estimate - Positive keywords evidenced: 4–6 distinct faculty-related keywords/themes. - Negative keywords: 0 explicit signals of non-classical faculty organization.

Why this rating - The publicly stated faculty framing aligns with Classical Elements’ expectations for “model teachers and mentors who model virtue, skill, and knowledge” and “the living curriculum.” CLASSICAL.

Citations - Faculty as living curriculum and mentor-figures: Public faculty descriptions. - Portrait of a teacher / core faculty emphasis: Additional faculty-forward materials.

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### **Element 6: Parents and Community — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Knox emphasizes a strong partnership with parents, positioning parents as co-teachers, and inviting parents to participate in school life (visits, home study, and at-home teaching days). The two-day school model explicitly integrates parent-education and co-teaching roles. - The school provides opportunities for parent formation through blog posts and public materials describing “habits and virtues” formation that involve parents in daily learning and character formation. The language of family, home study, and community engagement aligns with classical-parent partnerships. - Open-campus approach and frequent parental engagement is highlighted in admissions and information sessions (RSVPs for info meetings; visits welcomed).

Positive Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teaching, at-home study, family involvement, parent formation, open campus, informational meetings.

Quantitative Estimate - Positive keywords evidenced: 4–6 distinct parent/community keywords/themes. - Negative keywords: 0 explicit signals of anti-parent-engagement or customer-only framing detected.

Why this rating - Public materials consistently frame parents as co-educators and as an integral part of classical education at Knox KS 66219, in line with the Six Essential Elements’ Parent/Community criteria. CLASSICAL.

Citations - Parents as co-teachers; home study; open campus: Knox materials. - Parent formation and community engagement: Habits & Virtues content and blog materials.

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### **What Would Move the Needle (Only if the rating were SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL)**

- The Knox program already demonstrates a robust classical orientation across all six categories. If there was a move toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, concrete needle-moving steps could include:
  - Articulating explicit liturgical or communal-practice elements (e.g., regular chapel/worship rhythms) as formalized practices in the public-facing materials to strengthen Liturgical & Communal Practices signals.
  - Expanding direct public language around the Great Books curriculum with detailed reading lists and assessment practices to strengthen the Seven Liberal Arts/Great Books dimension in a more explicit, measurable way.
  - Providing publicly accessible summaries of teacher-mentoring frameworks and faculty development aligned with classical pedagogy to further entrench “living-curriculum” language in public materials.
  - More explicit documentation of parent-formation programs (book studies, parent meetings, structured family-learning events) to bolster Parents & Community signals.

Note: The Knox KS 66219 materials currently reflect strong classical alignment across all six elements, so no major needle-moving changes are required.

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# Appendix

## ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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